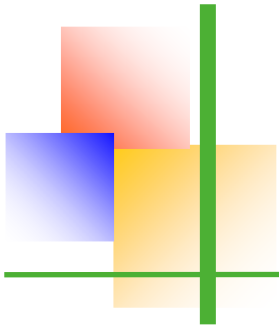




Annual Report

2013 - 2014

Coodu Trust
www.coodustrust.org



ANNUAL REPORT 2013-14

The year 2013-2014 represents a milestone in our activities as we transit and prepare ourselves for intensive grassroots activities to selected blocks and villages in five districts and technical and support services to development efforts in other places.

Now we have decided to work intensively among the communities on specific issues affecting them. We have selected Dindigul, Karur, Tirunelveli, Tiruchirappali and Virudhunagar districts for such intensive community development work including, Livelihood, women development, micro credit, health care, sanitation, environment, agriculture, HIV/AIDS and other activities addressing specific local problems for the next 10 years.

Though we have reached a turnover of over 10 million rupees, we have so far worked only on the basis of contracts and billing with government departments and with support from local communities. From this year onwards we have decided to seek funds and partnerships with funding sources outside the Tamil Nadu government based on the suggestions from the committee members and the advisory board members.

I thank all the staff members, community leaders, retired and current government officials, committee members and the advisory board members for their continued overwhelming support for the yet another thoughtful and eventful year.

Warm Regards

S.Jagadeesan

Director





Vision

"Self Sufficient, Self Governed communities that thrive together as a collaborative economy where every activity is an enterprise and every enterprise is a Social Enterprise."

Mission

- To support the delivery of all Government efforts as a Social Enterprise that maximises the benefit to the society.
- To develop Social Enterprises as a sustainable model for Growth and Development.
- To use Technology and Science responsibly for development without ignoring conventional wisdom.
- To demonstrate Collaboration as a powerful way for communities to be strong and grow.
- To innovate and learn while sharing every learning and knowledge with the world.
- To help Communities that work collaboratively to become Self Sufficient on every need and develop Self Governance models for such communities
- To incubate and nurse ideas to growth in Agriculture, Industry, Enterprise and Governance.

Board of Trustees

Sl.No	Name	Qualification	Office held
1	Mr. S. Jagadeesan	B.Sc., MBA,	Managing Trustee
2	Ms. B. Hemachitra	M.Sc., B.Ed.,	Committee Member
3	Mr. C.T.V. Chidambara Kumar	B.Com,	Committee Member
4	Mr. S. Raja	B.A.,	Committee Member
5	Ms. P. Mahalakshmi	M.Sc., M.Phil,	Committee Member
6	Mr. D. Srinivasan	M.Sc., M.Phil, B.Ed.,	Committee Member
7	Mr. K. Samidurai	M.Sc.,	Committee Member
8	Ms. S. Rani	M.A.,	Committee Member



Advisory Board

Sl. No.	Name	Qualification	Designation	Years of Experience	Specialization
1	Mr. C.R.Gunashekar	B.B.A, PGDM (IIPM),	Consultant, UNAIDS, UNDP, FHI, New Delhi	25 years	Monitoring and Evaluation
2	Dr.Rai	Ph.D.,	Consultant, ICAR, (Rtrd.), New Delhi	47 years	Agricultural Extension and Rural Sociology
3	Mr. C.P.Chandra Ban Singh	B.Sc (Agri), M.B.A	Consultant, Deputy Director (Agri)(Rtrd), Madurai	46 years	Cultivation aspect of Agriculture and Horticultural Crops
4	Dr.P. Venkatesan	M.Sc (Agri), M.B.A., Ph.D.,	Senior Scientist, NARM, Hyderabad.	15 years	Environmental Assessment and Social auditing
5	Mr. P.P. Saravanan	M.Sc (Forestry)	SMS (Agro Forestry), KVK, Gandhigram Rural Institute, Dindigul.	20 years	Watershed Management
6	Dr. K.A. Ponnusamy	M.Sc., Ph.D.,	Director, Agriculture Extension, TNAU, Coimbatore	42 years	Participatory Rural Appraisal and Social auditing
7	Dr. P.J. Pandian	M.Sc., Ph.D.,	Professor & Head, Water Technology Centre, TNAU, Coimbatore	35 years	Water System Deficiency Monitoring & Evaluation and Modernisation in Irrigation
8	Mr. Leo James Sengo	MSW, MPhil	National Consultant	20 years	Environment and Market Research
9	Dr.P.N.Ananth	M.Sc., Ph.D.,	International Consultant	10 years	Fisheries Extension, Participatory Impact Monitoring and Assessment
10	Mr. C.Mohan	Diploma in Civil Engg.	Engineering Consultant	25 years	Water bodies and structural creating



Genesis and Growth

Coodu Trust emerged in year 2000 based on the motivation of a few young and dynamic like minded persons and professionals who pledged to do efficient, constructive and everlasting social development work for the under privileged of the society to develop self sufficient and self reliant communities. The name 'Coodu' signifies 'Nest' - a place of rest, comfort and security for those in search of the same.

Coodu trust is a not for profit voluntary organization to under take charitable, educational and development activities for the welfare of downtrodden and marginalized needy people of society, including of fourteen districts of Tamil Nadu on watershed programmes and all the thirty districts for various social development work.

Over the years Coodu Trust emerged as one of the leading NGO in watershed development activities in Tamil Nadu especially on community organization and training programmes and research and documentation on various rural development issues.

However we have decided in year 2012, to move on to two types of activities, Intensive grassroots activities in selected villages and districts and Technical and support services to development activities wherever needed.

We have decided to work intensively among the communities on specific issues affecting them. We have selected Dindigul, Karur, Tirunelveli, Tiruchirappali and Virudhunagar districts for such intensive community development work including, Livelihood, women development, micro credit, health care, sanitation, environment, agriculture, HIV/AIDS and other activities addressing specific local problems for the following years.

The following years are going to be very challenging to create opportunities on specific issues to serve the communities with intensive grassroots activities on diversified development issues.

Activities

Dairy Farming:

Rearing cows is a prevalent practice followed by all the farmers of India. The scientific advancement made it possible for farmers to rear high yielding breeds like HF breeds, Sindh and Jersey in Tamil nadu. But unawareness about the technologies to be followed, the farmers were unable to reap the full benefit from the high yielding breeds. The Coodu Trust after understanding the hindering factors, organized skill enhancement trainings in Scientific Methods of rearing cows to about 2476 farm women encompassed in the districts of Dindigul, Karur, Tirunelveli, Virudhunagar, Salem and Vellore districts.. In the training calf rearing, Integrated feeding schedule, balanced diet, Importance of Micronutrient in milk yield enhancement, vaccination schedule, Milking procedure and disease management strategies were dealt.



Apart from the above Hygiene and sanitary measures to be adopted for clean-milk production was insisted to the trainees. Preparation of Panner, yoghurt and other milk products related skills were also imparted with a view to enhance the total profitability of cow rearing.

Goat Rearing

Goats are called as poormans cow. It is the main source of income to marginal farmers and also to landless labourers. The local type of goat breeds are reared in our area. This breeds are excellent adopters of our ecosystems but with less no. of kids per kidding and comparatively low weight gainers. The poor management adopted by farmers also results in less output. The needs for the improvement of output and profitability of goat farming were identified by the Coodu trust through focused group discussion and individual contact. It was decided to disseminate the technologies concerning the scientific management of goat farming through trainings. The skills of goat reares (Farm women and Rural youth) were improved by exposing to the scientific methods of goat farming. In the trainings, advantages of high yielding breeds like Tellicherry, boer, Sirohi etc., Pros and Cons of local breeds, feed Management, Kid management, disease management balanced diet for the kids and adults were dealt to the trainees. The main focus was given for Upgrading the Genetic makeup of local breeds by cross breeding female goats with male bucks of improved breeds especially through Artificial Insemination of Semen of Boer and Tellicherry. Twenty four trainings were organized in Dindigul and Karur districts covering 1775 farm women and 1226 rural youth.

Mushroom Cultivation

Mushroom is the cheapest source of Protein energy to the people. Mushroom cultivation is gaining more attention as a possibility to use agricultural wastes, and to help alleviate poverty and food insecurity. It provides an opportunity for the entrepreneur for good profit with less investment. The produce claims demand all round the year from the consumers. The Coodu Trust identified 1267 potential entrepreneurs from 5 districts of Tamil Nadu and organized skill enhanced trainings in which knowhow about mushrooms, their health properties and benefits, their cultivation, processing and how to run a mushroom production farm were dealt with practicals and theoretical classes. The Oyster mushroom production and Spawn production were concentrated. The composting technologies of the agricultural produces were dealt in detail as it forms the basis for mushroom cultivation. Preparation of value added products were demonstrated to the participants. Harvesting, Packing and Marketing strategies were dealt by the successful mushroom entrepreneurs that boosted the confidence of the trainees.

Backyard Poultry Farming

It is a age old practice of rural India and most common entrepreneurship activity of all farmers and landless poor rural peasants. To improve the socio-economic status of the traditional farmers, backyard poultry is a handy enterprise with low-cost initial investment,



but high economic return along with guarantee for improving protein deficiency among the poor. The desi strains of birds are reared by the farmers under the backyard system. Poor egg yield (70 to 80 eggs per bird per year), poor weight gain, poor brooding percentage and sudden disease outbreaks reduce the income from this venture. Unhygienic condition and unscientific methods of rearing birds further diminished the returns. Coodu Trust designed trainings to overcome the hurdles and to enhance the productivity of individual birds in which technologies concerned with the improved strains of desi birds with more egg laying and weight gain, housing for backyard poultry, Brooding of chicks, Feeding Management and Health care management covering vaccination schedule and disease prevention and management practices and Marketing strategies were dealt. Fifty trainings were organized in Dindigul, Karur, Tirunelveli and Salem districts of Tamil Nadu. Each training was of two days duration. 935 marginal farmers, 782 landless women and 456 rural youth were trained.

Vermicomposting

It is apparent that the farmers are harvesting the needed produce from the land and ignore the residues. It should be understood that during the removal of plants, we also remove nutrients from the soil which were absorbed and stored in the plants. Hence, the recycling of the residues will give back essential nutrients to the soil in an effective manner with cheap cost. Composting is the best option for the farmers for recycling the residues. Vermicomposting is the most relevant and efficient method. The term vermicomposting means the use of earthworms for composting organic residues. Earthworms can consume practically all kinds of organic matter and they can eat their own body weight per day, e.g. 1 kg of worms can consume 1 kg of residues every day. The excreta (castings) of the worms are rich in nitrate, available forms of P, K, Ca and Mg. The passage of soil through earthworms promotes the growth of bacteria and actinomycetes. Actinomycetes thrive in the presence of worms and their content in worm casts is more than six times that in the original soil. Vermicompost, Vermicast and Vermiwash are the different forms of produce obtained after composting. Coodu Trust conducted 28 trainings on vermicompost technologies in Karur district to 1367 small and marginal farmers. In this programme, site selection, handling the residues, preparation of composting materials, Earthworms handling methods, Management of composting pits and collection of vermicompost, Vermicast and Vermiwash were dealt. Harvest, Packing and Marketing skills were also instilled to the participants.

Organic Farming Poultry Farming

Healthy and nutritious food is the most essential need of the humanity. Irrational use of technical products especially chemicals not only acts as slow poison to human but also it deteriorates the soil and degrades environment. To evade the problem it is inevitable to use agricultural inputs rationally of organic nature and to familiarize organic agriculture among rural peasants. Organic production is a holistic system designed to optimize the



productivity and fitness of diverse communities within the agro-ecosystem, including soil organisms, plants, livestock and people. The principal goal of organic production is to develop enterprises that are sustainable and harmonious with the environment. The organic standards generally prohibit products of genetic engineering and animal cloning, synthetic pesticides, synthetic fertilizers, sewage sludge, synthetic drugs, synthetic food processing aids and ingredients, and ionizing radiation. Prohibited products and practices must not be used on certified organic farms for at least three years prior to harvest of the certified organic products. Livestock must be raised organically and fed 100 per cent organic feed ingredients. Coodu Trust organized trainings with the view of adopting the following methods in agriculture as to produce residue-free nutritious food.

- protect the environment, minimize soil degradation and erosion, decrease pollution, optimize biological productivity and promote a sound state of health
- maintain long-term soil fertility by optimizing conditions for biological activity within the soil
- maintain biological diversity within the system
- recycle materials and resources to the greatest extent possible within the enterprise
- provide attentive care that promotes the health and meets the behavioural needs of livestock
- prepare organic products, emphasizing careful processing, and handling methods in order to maintain the organic integrity and vital qualities of the products at all stages of production
- rely on renewable resources in locally organized agricultural systems.

128 trainings composed of lectures and demonstrations were given to 2345 farmers and 1456 rural youth. The organic products useful as fertilizer and pesticides were briefed to the participants along with the demonstration of preparations and application methods. Exposure on biofertilisers, biocontrol agents use of traps, cultural and mechanical means of pest and disease control were elaborated to the participants.

Training on Coconut Climbing

Coconut is the most favoured crop of all farmers in Tamil Nadu. But recently the area under coconut is diminishing and also the productivity has gone down. The hindering factors of coconut production is multifarious with the mainstay on frequent drought and fluctuating rainfall. Labour shortage especially skilled labour for palm cleaning and harvesting nuts are exceptionally high in all the areas of coconut cultivation. Coodu Trust designed skill oriented training to rural youth for palm cleaning and palm climbing with palm climbing devices designed by TNAU and another device popularized by Coconut Development board. Each training was tailored for 5 days duration. About 220 rural youth were trained in 7 training programmes

72 rural youth took this skill for earning and now they are earning upto Rs.750.00 per day charging Rs.15 to 20/ per tree.



Nursery Raising

One amongst the most important climate resilient technologies is to create tree cover especially in Non conventional forest areas through social forestry activities like farm forestry, Road side Plantations, Canal bank plantations etc. The quality of the saplings to be planted decides the success of the plantations. Keeping this in view, Coodu trust organized training programmes to rural youth on Nursery Technology of Forest and Horticultural crops. The skill required for raising seedlings of tree species with multipurpose utility and vegetative propagation technologies needed for raising fruit crops ornamentals and flower crops were instilled to the participants. 15 training programmes of 10 days duration was organized in Karur, Dindigul and Virudhunagar districts to 300 rural youth.

Farm Field School

Farm Field school is a extension strategy where the package of practices from seed sowing of the crops to marketing and or post harvest handling of the produce or rearing animals will be taken up in the farmers field. The selected technologies will be imparted to the beneficiaries through lectures/demonstrations in the field itself. The activities will be tailored to suit all the stages of development of crops or animals. The FFS is a suitable method to insert the required advanced technologies into the minds of farmers as it covers whole cropping period or animal development stages with demonstrations and at farmers field itself.

The FFS was conducted in Cultivation of Onion, Cotton and Maize. Three FFs were conducted with 30 farmers in each crop and totally 90 farmers were trained in Reddiarcha-tram block.

Check dam construction

The water scarcity has started to threaten the mere human survival of several places. Recurrent drought, irrational rainfall with overexploitation of the underground water sources resulted in the water scarcity. The drinking water scarcity is now felt in all the residential areas of our country and also agricultural production is at the minimum level especially in rainfed areas which contributes to more than 60 % of agricultural lands. To combat the problem is to harvest the rainwater and to increase the ground water recharge.

Coodu Trust believes in the fact that the maximum benefit can be reaped that any programme only if it suits the people's need and implemented with the people participation. With the contribution of the beneficiaries (10%), Coodu Trust organized and coordinated in construction of 21 checkdams in Virudhunagar, Tirunelveli and Dindigul districts supported by WGDP Water Resource Creation Programmes. The activity benefitted 918 farmers through recharge of their wells and anchored drinking water availability in 76 villages.



Water and Sanitation

Water and sanitation management strategies offers amenities to humans to have a hygienic condition for a healthy living. The strategies aims to reduce/nullify the human mortality due to water-borne diseases and diseases caused by unhygienic conditions, that encompass activities like construction of individual household latrines, establishment and management of Rural Sanitary Mart would supply hardware sanitary materials for construction of toilets, construction and supervision of village sanitary complex for Women, upgradation of Rural Sanitary Latrines, construction of School Toilets and school sanitation awareness programme, construction of Baby-Friendly Toilets and toilets for Anganwadi centres, Waste Water Management, Solid Waste Management, reduction of Pollution in the villages and integrated environmental protection and development. In order to improve the sanitation conditions of the rural poor we built 8442 individual household low cost latrines in 8 districts. As part of the women economic development activity, we are running a rural sanitary mart at our Training center in Mylampatti managed by trained women.

Health Programmes in Schools

Personal hygiene and healthy conditions of the youth decides the future of India. Keeping this in view Coodu Trust organized awareness programmes in schools about the importance of self hygiene and its advantages, ill -effects of various diseases caused by unhygienic conditions, importance of nutrition, Nutritive value of different fruits and vegetables etc., The school students were exposed to various issues of health through lecture, video show and charts. 32 programmes were organized in 5 districts of Tamil Nadu to abott 2435 students in 32 schools.

Women Development, Self Help Groups (SHGs) & Micro-Credits

Coodu Trust formed 1345 men and women Self Help Groups in 11 districts of Tamil Nadu. Coodu Trust enabled these SHGs members for revolving fund, economic assistance through SGSY, IWDP, Magalir Thittam, NABAD, THADCO and other nationalized banks. The total financial assistance of nearly 6 Crores Rupees was given to the members of SHGs with the able support of the Coodu Trust. Self Help Groups were formed to promote savings habit among the women SHG members. Coodu Trust trainers addressed the women in watershed areas to explain about the need for the formation of such groups and the importance of the role of women in Self Help Groups. The selected women were trained on income generating activity such as Mushroom Cultivation and vermi-composting. Through such training, women were trained. Over the period of time, each of the SHGs evolve through the processes of Group Formation (leading to Federation), Capital Formation through revolving funds, and Skill Development with a view to provide skills development and motivate women to become women entrepreneurs and leaders. The major viable economic activities that trained SHGs have undertaken include: Community Herbal Nursery, Community Nurseries, Vermi-Casting/ Composting Production Centre, and Mushroom Production Centre. The poor landless labourers of these SHG members were once struggled for their live-



lihoods. The intervention from Coodu Trust changed the lives of the rural poor and the members wisely used the money for their livelihood development through petty trades, livestock development and small scale cottage industries. Definitely the quality of life of these SHG members is drastically improving over the years.

TN-IAMWARN Project Virdhunagar

The Tamil Nadu Irrigated Agriculture Modernization and Water - Bodies Restoration and Management (TN-IAMWARM) Project is being implemented by the Government of Tamil Nadu with a loan/credit from the (International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)/International Development Association (IDA) in the amount of about US\$ 485 million with the objective of improving irrigation service delivery and productivity of irrigated agriculture with effective integrated water resources management in a river basin / sub-basin framework in the State. Productivity and incomes from irrigated agriculture and allied activities would require the coordinated effort of the concerned line departments namely, Agriculture, Horticulture, Animal Husbandry, Fisheries, Agriculture Engineering, Agriculture Marketing etc. providing required support to and working in close co ordination with the WUAs, (DCs and PCs if required). To focus attention on the agricultural intensification, diversification, productivity improvement, introduction of improved technology, providing required agro-processing, agricultural marketing and agribusiness input. This consultancy of providing capacity building of Water Users Associations (WUAs) for successful implementation of Participatory Irrigation Management (PIM), and to ensure with necessary ways and means for the sustainability of the outcomes, contemplated under the project. "Creating awareness" about the Project and its expected outputs, salient features of the TNFMIS Act and the procedures to be adopted in its implementation. "Creating awareness" among the Women members and induce them for their effective participation in various activities of WUAs is also an important task of the Consultants. "Creating awareness" among WUAs members regarding water management techniques, agro engineering technologies such as micro irrigation sprinkler, fertigation and other water harvesting techniques. Specifically we also involve, capacity building of all the members of the managing committee of the WUAs, members of the four sub-committees. Post project management training programmes were organized to 500 members in 10 batches.

Sewing Machine Operator Training

Sewing machine Operator courses were offered to 1500 women beneficiaries (500 women sprawling over three blocks of dindigul district : 500 members of 3 blocks in Karur district and 500 members of two blocks in Tirunelveli district). The training period was 3 months.

School Sanitation Programmes

The Water and Sanitation Campaign device measures to reduce mortality / morbidity due to such water - related diseases, undertake to create awareness about the importance of health through self-hygiene and also to create awareness about the ill effects of unhygienic and open toilet system.



About 1000 students were covered in this programme encompassing 14 schools of dindigul and Tirunelveli districts.

Computer Skill Enhancement

Computer skill development offers immense opportunity for the youths to get immediate employment. Hence, computer skill enhancement in MS word, Excel, Adobe Photoshop, Tally software were provided to rural youths who have passed plus two. 5 Programmes were organized to 100 members of youth in Karur district.

Organisation Detail

Name	:	Coodu Trust
Office addresses	:	Registered and Head Office H-83, R.M. Colony, 6th & 7th Cross, Dindigul. Tamil Nadu - 624 001 Project Office 14/75, Trichy Main Road, Mylampatti, Tharagampatti, Karur - 621301. Field Office Coodu Trust Farmers Academy 45A, Kuravan pathai, Vellianai South, Vellianai, Karur district. Project Office Thottakudi Main Road, Mundradaippu, Nanguneri Tk., Tirunelveli - 627 152. Project Office No.5, Meenakshi Nagar, Thailakulam, Sriviliputhur - 626 135, Virudhunagar Dt.
Training Centre's	:	Coodu Trust Training Centre, 14/75, Trichy Main Road, Mylampatti, Tharagampatti (Po), Karur Dt. - 621301. Coodu Trust Training Centre, Thottakudi Main Road, Mundradaippu, Nanguneri Tk., Tirunelveli - 627 152.
Contact person	:	S. Jagadeesan, Director
Registration details	:	Register No.150/2000 Date : 20.06.2000 Under Indian Trust Act.
PAN No.	:	AAATC5133E
Service tax No.	:	AAATC5133ESD001
FCRA No.	:	075890364
Telephone	:	0451-2461362
Fax no.	:	0451-2421959
Mobile	:	9842127886
E-mail Id	:	director.coodustrust@gmail.com
Website	:	www.coodustrust.org
Nature of Agency	:	Registered, Voluntary Social Welfare Democratic Non-Government Organisation
Financial approvals	:	80G & 12A under Income Tax Act FCRA from Ministry of Home Affairs
Working districts	:	Dindigul, Karur, Madurai, Namakkal, Perambalur, Pudukottai, Ramnad, Salem, Sivagangai, Theni, Trichy, Tirunelveli, Virudhunagar, Kancheepuram and Tiruvallur districts.